

on Apple's Web site. Some are very useful; others are practically nonsensical goofiness.

There is a widget that exists solely to imitate the sound of a broken radio; that is the only thing it does. Still, it has in excess of six thousand downloads to its credit (and no, we did not download it). That doesn't mean there aren't any useful widgets; there are a lot of genuinely useful ones that can make life a tad easier.

5.3.3 The Best Of All Worlds

Mac OS X is the only operating system that can run Linux and even Windows applications at near-native speeds. There are two types of software that can enable this: those that allow you to run any operating system as a separate application on top of OS X, and those that allow you to run your Windows and Linux applications, seamlessly integrated on Mac OS X without the overhead of running the entire operating system. And it's not rocket science either; it is very easy. This text is being written on Microsoft Office Word 2007 running on Windows Vista Ultimate, which is running on Mac OS X using the Parallels Desktop virtualisation software.

Here's another bit of trivia: installing Windows on a Mac is easier than installing it on your regular PC. When you start Parallels Desktop, it starts a very user-friendly wizard that guides you through choosing the operating system you wish to install and entering your name and serial number. After that, all you have to do is insert the CD/DVD. Or you can even make an image on your hard drive and point Parallels to that; the installation is more than twice as fast if you use a disk image. Once the installation has started, you can go and get yourself a cup of coffee while Parallels automatically answers all the dialog boxes that pop up during the installation, and installs the OS for you. Once that is done, it automatically installs Parallels Tools, which allow your mouse to work seamlessly between both OSes and enable support for drag-and-drop functionality between the two operat-